

What's Happening in Ballard

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1. Story

After selecting the neighborhood of Ballard, Seattle to explore and visualize, we brainstormed topics that we thought would translate well into a visualization for this assignment. We arrived at Ballard to conduct our observation just after 1:00 pm, and saw that many restaurants were already closed for the day. We were intrigued by this and settled on visualizing the opening and closing times of restaurants in Ballard.

2. Notebook & Dataset - Relevant to theme

Link:

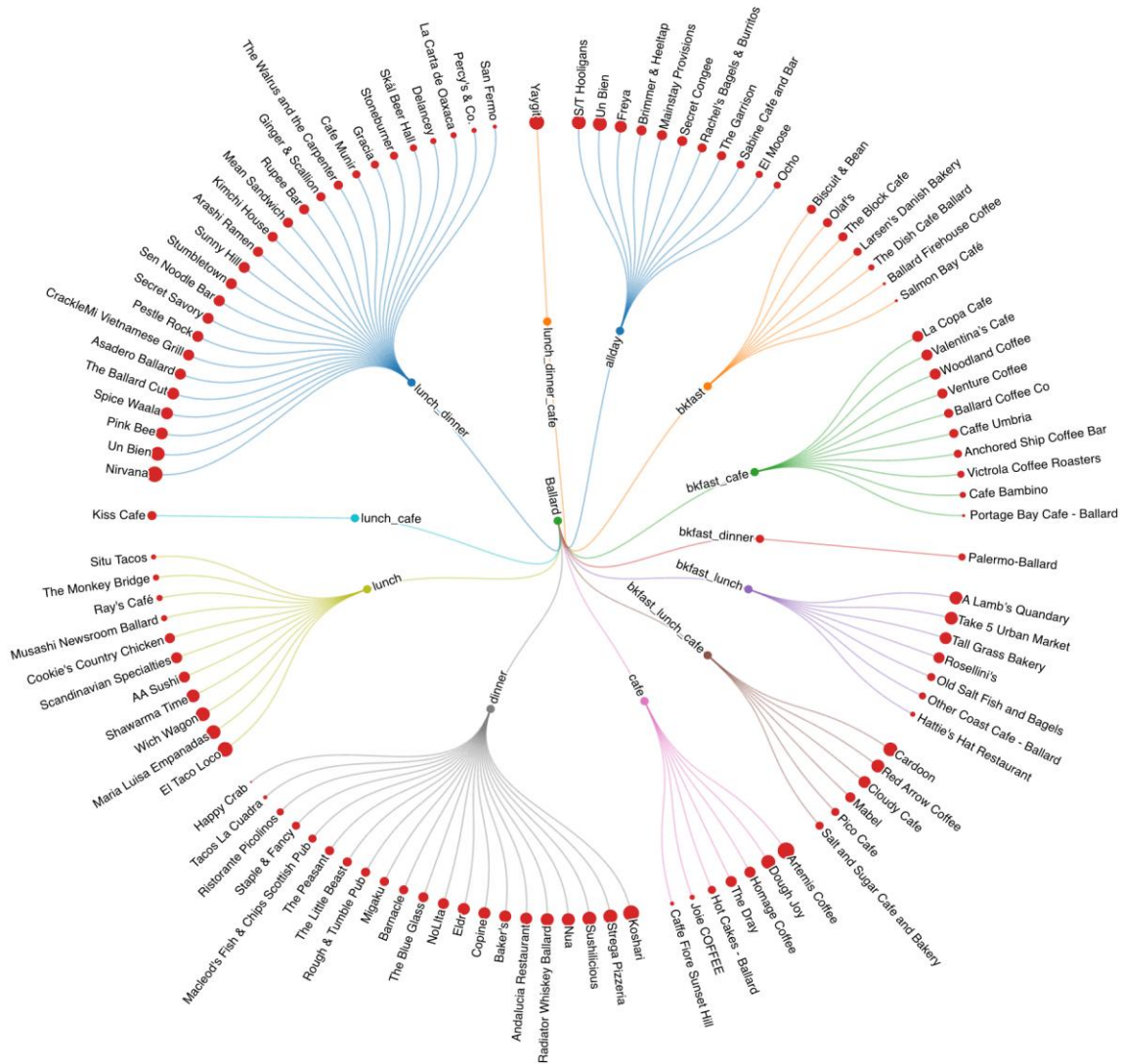
(colab.research.google.com/drive/1qqMUdXOG5s3vxhThs9IBOG4WVEOLrUzq?usp=sharing)

Our initial plan was to plot our visual by the store's operating hours. However, this required additional coding beyond what our template provided. Our attempts to access the store hours proved complicated, and we needed more time to properly implement it than we were able to give. We pivoted to picking a proxy variable for operating hours. We came up with categorizing restaurants by the food served at different times of day. We scraped Yelp for restaurants identified as cafe, breakfast, lunch, or dinner locations. After we gathered 100 results from each category, 400 results in total, we compiled them into a unified spreadsheet and cleaned the data.

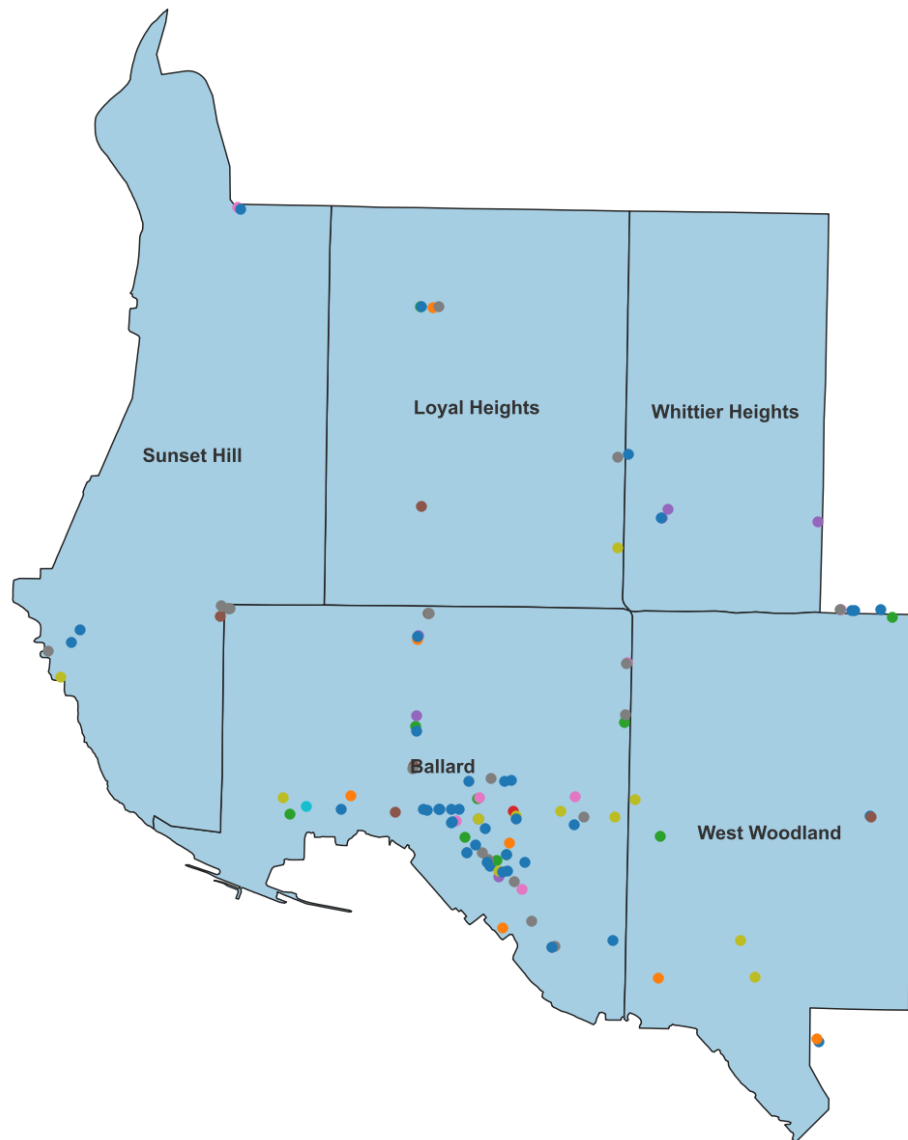
We noticed that some restaurants fell outside the boundary of Ballard, since Yelp recommends restaurants within a proximity. We compared the extent of Ballard's latitude and longitude boundaries to the coordinate information of our restaurants and removed those which fell outside of this area. We observed that some restaurants were present in multiple categories (e.g. a cafe would usually also identify as serving breakfast). We decided to manually create new identifiers based on the food they served.

3. Visualizations

Our first visualization was a radial dendrogram (shown below). It was created per the lab instructions. Starting at the center, it connects Ballard to each of our categories, and from there to each restaurant under its classification. This is an effective display of the various options for each time of day.



Our second visualization is a local map of Ballard (and the surrounding region) with the restaurants from our dataset. This required several additional steps. We first obtained a neighborhood shapefile from Seattle GeoData, filtered it to Ballard, and exported it to QGIS. Because the Ballard shapefile included five subsections, we added titles for each one. We then imported our dataset and created categorized symbols using the provided latitude and longitude values. Finally, we matched the point colors to those used in the dendrogram, allowing us to visualize the locations and concentrations of different restaurant types.



Our third and final visualization was a combination of the two. We put the location map in the center of our dendrogram as instructed. We wanted to include both of our original visualizations so that all the details were clearly visible.

